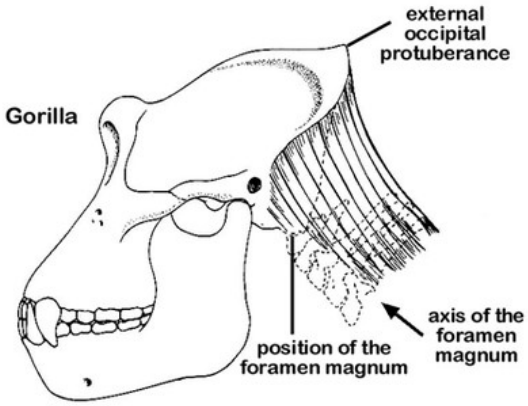
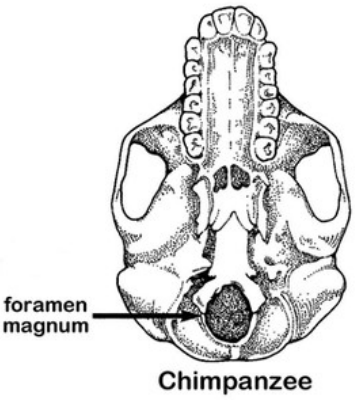
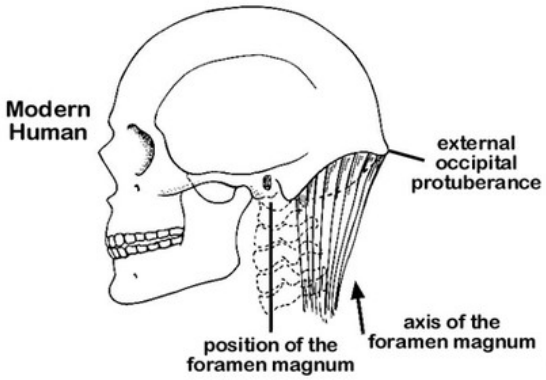
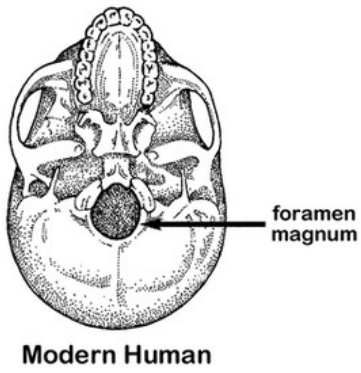




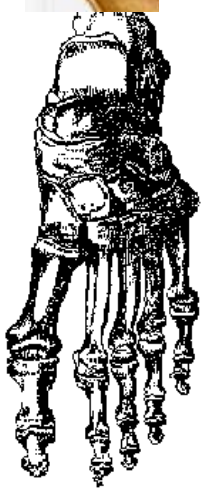




Evidence for bipedality in Australopithecus afarensis







Dorsal view of human foot



Unlike in nonhuman apes, the toe is in alignment with the other digits. The foot-arch is also present.

The heel is much larger than in chimpanzees. It serves as a shock absorber during bipedal motion.



The anatomy of the pelvis is similar to that of humans.



The femoral neck is long and slender.

The femur is at an angle at the knee joint (the valgus angle). This orientation allows for the midline of the body to pass between the feet.